# Keep track of the change

CodeRabbit Change Stack | Formbricks #8650 | Parth Pawar

Make Change Stack easier to review without losing what it can do. I focused on understanding the change, checking its code and tracking progress. My assumption: keeping the layer, file, explanation and review state together takes extra effort.

| What I noticed | What I chose, and why |
|---|---|
| **Summary points share a broad range. Expanding also moves the code.** | Keep the original summary wording visible. Expand in place, with a line link beside each statement. Reading and navigation become separate actions; the whole function remains available. |
| **Layers and files are separate. Following a guard leaves a return trip to remember.** | Nest files under their layer. Inspect guard opens the dependency; Return restores the caller and position. This keeps one wide code pane; a side-by-side option would need more horizontal space. |
| **Actions span several control groups.** | Keep frequent file actions beside the filename and display controls beside the diff. Put secondary actions in Tools. That adds a click; I'd check whether people can find them. |
| **File and layer totals need a clear scope.** | Start with This file and keep Entire layer one click away. Counts follow the scope: access.ts has 3 messages; its layer has 15. The diff stays in place. |
| **Seen, viewed and submitted mean different things.** | Opening a file leaves progress alone. Mark viewed updates its checkbox and the count, with Undo. Summary seen stays separate from the PR decision. |

## What I gave up

Context takes space from the diff; Focus gives it back. Precise highlights may hide relevant branches. Inspect + Return means switching views. Status-first comments need testing with open findings; this sample has one resolved thread.

## What I kept

The header, merged state, layer order, counts, complexity labels, J/K and Focus remain. Comments retain their metadata and expand in place; a separate line link opens code. Gray marks selection; orange highlights linked code.

## What I would test

Compare the same task in both versions, varying which comes first. Watch for missed branches, lost context and buried findings. Try a PR with more dependencies. Then revise the panels, links or comment order. Check Overview filters and how new commits affect links and viewed progress.

Observations and assumptions from using this PR, not developer research. Seven of 52 diffs at commit 23cdac2; manually mapped links; one paraphrased finding, with two reply bodies omitted. Secondary workflows are previews. Submit is disabled for the merged PR. Work exceeded the 1–2 hour brief. Paper requires sign-in.

Paper design | Working prototype